

Did you know?

SHAKESPEARE TIMELINE



Elizabeth I ruled England for 45 years

1558
Elizabeth, daughter of Henry VIII and Anne Boleyn, is crowned queen.

1564
William Shakespeare is born in Stratford-upon-Avon, Warwickshire, England.

1568
Richard Burbage is born. He will become one of the greatest tragic actors of his age and will eventually portray Hamlet, Lear, and Othello in Shakespeare's productions.

1582
Shakespeare is married to a local farmer's daughter, Anne Hathaway.

1583
Shakespeare's first child, his daughter Susanna, is born. The Queen's Company, an acting troupe, is founded.



The house in which Shakespeare was born

1585
Shakespeare's wife gives birth to twins, Judith and Hamnet.

c.1587
Shakespeare leaves his family in Stratford-upon-Avon to establish himself in London as an actor and playwright.

1588
The English naval fleet, headed by Lord Howard of Effingham, defeats the invading Spanish Armada of nearly 150 ships, sent by Philip II, King of Spain. The English are helped by fierce storms that scatter and sink the Spanish ships. This was one of the most dramatic episodes in England's bitter war with Spain, which lasted from 1585 to 1604.

1591
Shakespeare begins to court the patronage of the royal family and dedicates his poem *Venus and Adonis* to Henry Wriothesley, Earl of Southampton. Henry is possibly the young man addressed in Shakespeare's *Sonnets*, which Shakespeare is believed to have started writing around this time. Henry dies in 1593.

1592
The plague sweeps through London, leading to the closure of many of the city's playhouses for the next two years.

1594
Shakespeare becomes a founding member of the acting group the Lord Chamberlain's Men. The company performs at the Theater, north London. Shakespeare both acts with and writes for the troupe. Over the next two years, he begins to gain recognition as the leading playwright in London.

1596
Shakespeare's son, Hamnet, dies at the age of 11. John Shakespeare, Shakespeare's father, reapplies successfully for a family coat of arms.

1597–1598
Shakespeare purchases the New Place residence in Stratford-upon-Avon. It is around this time that Shakespeare begins to reach artistic maturity.

1599
The Globe Theater is built in Bankside, London, from the timbers of the old Theater. As a shareholder, Shakespeare gets about 10 percent of the profits.



Cannonball used by English fleet

1600
The Fortune theater opens in London.

1601
Shakespeare's father dies.

1603
Elizabeth I dies and James VI of Scotland becomes James VI of England. The plague sweeps through London once again. The Lord Chamberlain's Men become the King's Men, who are soon the favourite acting company at the royal court.

1605
Gunpowder plot to kill King James.

1607
Shakespeare's daughter Susanna marries Dr. John Hall.

1608
The King's Men begin to play at Blackfriars. Shakespeare's mother dies.

1609
The *Sonnets* are published.

1612
During the next few years, Shakespeare gradually retires from London and moves back to Stratford-upon-Avon. Although he buys a house in Blackfriars in 1613, he does not spend much time there.

1613
The Globe is burned down when the thatched roof catches fire.

1616
Shakespeare's daughter Judith marries Thomas Quiney. Shakespeare becomes ill and revises his will. A month later, on April 23, he dies and is buried at Holy Trinity Church in Stratford-upon-Avon.

1623
Shakespeare's First Folio is published by his fellow actors. It contains 36 of the playwright's dramas.



Rossetti painting depicts opening of *Henry IV, part 1*



Shakespeare memorial in Hyde Park, London